

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 7 6

♥ A 4 2

♦ 6 3

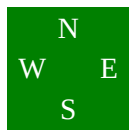
♣ K Q 10 9

♠ A K

♥ J 6 5

♦ A K J 4

♣ J 8 6 5



♠ 3 2

♥ 9 7

♦ Q 10 9 8 2

♣ A 7 4 2

♠ Q 9 8 5 4

♥ K Q 10 8 3

♦ 7 5

♣ 3

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♠3

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♦.

You obey partner and bid 2♥ but he then bids 2♠.

Partner has told you that he has an inviting, 9-point hand with 5 of each Major. He wants you to choose a Major and also decide whether to play game or partscore.

Despite your ♠s being so beautiful there are only two of them so you pick ♥s. And since you have a maximum 17 points you bid the game, 4♥.

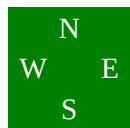
**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 8 7 3  
 ♥ K 10 9 6 5  
 ♦ 7 5  
 ♣ 9

♠ 9 2  
 ♥ J 8 3  
 ♦ A 10 6  
 ♣ 10 8 4 3 2



♠ Q 10 5  
 ♥ A Q 4  
 ♦ K J 4  
 ♣ K J 6 5

♠ J 6 4  
 ♥ 7 2  
 ♦ Q 9 8 3 2  
 ♣ A Q 7

| West       | North | East | South |
|------------|-------|------|-------|
|            |       | 1NT  | Pass  |
| 2♥         | Pass  | 2♠   | Pass  |
| 3♥         | Pass  | 4♠   |       |
| All Pass   |       |      |       |
| 4♠ by East |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥7   |       |      |       |

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♥.

You say 2♠. Partner then bids 3♥.

Partner has a game forcing hand and is 5-5 in the Majors. He has asked you to choose one of them to bid game in.

With 3 of each you might be inclined to choose your stronger one, ♥s, but in fact that doesn't really matter since partner is probably stronger in ♠s.

What does matter is those minor suits. If the opening lead is a ♣ or ♦, which is very likely, you want the lead to be coming into your hand, not partner's. And in general you would prefer to have the stronger hand remain concealed. So you bid 4♠ where you will be declarer, rather than 4♥ where partner would be declarer.

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7 6 2

♥ 8

♦ 6 5 2

♣ 7 5 4 3 2

♠ K Q 9 4

♥ A J 9 7 3

♦ 8 3

♣ A 6



♠ A 8 3

♥ 6 5 2

♦ Q J 10 9 4

♣ J 10

♠ 10 5

♥ K Q 10 4

♦ A K 7

♣ K Q 9 8

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass     | 2♦    | Pass | 3♥    |
| Pass     | 4♣    | Pass | 4♦    |
| Pass     | 6♥    |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

6♥ by South

Lead: ♣2

first round ♦ control, you bid 4♦.

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♦.

Just hold it a minute and DO NOT say 2♥. True, when partner transfers, you **almost** always just obey and complete the transfer. This is the one time when you don't. You had a 17 point 1NT opener with 4♥s and a doubleton. As soon as partner told you to bid ♥s your hand became worth 18 points because of the good trump support and the doubleton. So you inform partner of this by making the "super-accept" bid of 3♥. In other words, you complete the transfer with a jump.

Partner's eyes get big (but you aren't allowed to notice that) and he bids 4♣.

Partner's ♣ bid was not a suit, you already have an agreed suit, ♥s. The ♣ bid was showing you first round control in ♣s, and is a slam try by partner.

You continue the search for slam by showing your

That was all partner needed to hear, he jumps straight to 6♥.

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 10 4

♥ A K

♦ A K 9 7

♣ K Q 9 8

♠ 6 2

♥ Q 10 5 3

♦ Q J 5 3

♣ 10 6 4



♠ Q 9 8 5 3

♥ 7 2

♦ 8 6 4 2

♣ A 3

♠ A K 7

♥ J 9 8 6 4

♦ 10

♣ J 7 5 2

*West*

2NT

3♠

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by West

Lead: ♠2

*North*

Pass

Pass

*East*

3♥

3NT

*South*

Pass

Pass

You open 2NT and partner responds 3♥.

You bid 3♠, just as partner asked. He puts you in game at 3NT. Bid or pass?

Bid of course. You have an 8-card ♠ fit so you prefer ♠s to notrump.

As you can see, 3NT would surely go down with a ♥ lead, while 4♠ is cold.

One hand doesn't mean it will always be like this, but usually if you have an 8-card fit the Major suit game will be better than 3NT.